SUMMARY OF THE BUDGET

Thrust of the Budget

The Budget announces a ***'4-Point'*** Thrust areas they are –

1. Safety
2. Consolidation
3. Passenger Amenities
4. Fiscal Discipline

Some Achievements/Initiatives

- IR (Indian Railways) enters the one billion tonne ***Select Club*** joining Chinese, Russian and US Railways;
- IR also joins ***Select Club*** running freight trains of more than 10000 tonne load;
- *'Fuel Adjustment Component'* concept to be implemented linking tariffs with movement of fuel prices;
- Target of Rs 1000 crore each fixed for **RLDA** (Rail Land Development Authority) and **IRSDC** (IR Station Development Corporation to be raised through PPP in 2013-14;
- New fund – Debt Service Fund – to be set up to meet committed liabilities of debt servicing for WB and JICA loans for DFC and other future liabilities.

Measures for improving Safety & Security

- Making a *Corporate Safety Plan* for a ten year period (2014-2024)
- Elimination of 10,797 level crossings (LCs) during the 12th Plan and no addition of new LCs to the IR system henceforth
- Introduction of *Train Protection Warning System* on Automatic Signalling Systems
- Rigorous trials of the indigenously developed *Train Collision Avoidance System*